

UNLOCKING INDIAN TECH INNOVATION

A thought-provoking interview with
Sreekrishnan Venkateswaran,
CTO of Kyndryl India

Jayesh Shinde | jayesh@digit.in



**Sreekrishnan
Venkateswaran, CTO,
Kyndryl India**

In the ever-evolving landscape of technology, few leaders stand out as true visionaries, capable of steering their organisations through both present challenges and future opportunities. Sreekrishnan Venkateswaran, the CTO of Kyndryl India, is one such luminary. With pivotal roles at IBM and a remarkable portfolio of 27 US patents, of which seven have been instrumental in catalysing high-value IP licensing deals with tech giants like LinkedIn, Twitter/X, and Airbnb, Sreekrishnan also chairs Kyndryl's global patent review board on Network & Edge, a testament to his authority in shaping the company's intellectual property landscape. With an illustrious career spanning over 25 years, Sreekrishnan's expertise and innovative spirit are shaping the future of Indian tech innovation.

In an interview with Digit, Sreekrishnan delves into his professional journey, the significance of patents in fostering a culture of inno-

vation in India, nurturing Kyndryl India's next generation of tech leaders, and an important message for India's future technologists. Edited excerpts from our insightful conversation follow:

📺 Tell us about your professional journey?

I joined IBM directly from the campus of IIT Kanpur, where I was pursuing my master's in computer science and I was with IBM for 25 years, reaching the position of a distinguished engineer in 2016. When IBM spun off its technology services division into Kyndryl, I transitioned to the role of CTO Kyndryl India, and more recently I was named a Kyndryl Fellow, and additionally I served as a professor of practice in the Computer Science Department of BITS, Pilani, where I taught modern application architectures and AI.

So, throughout my career I have had the privilege of working on numerous captivating projects and if I were to

highlight one or two, maybe one from my early days and one more recent: In the early 2000s, I led the embedded firmware development for a life-saving medical device for IBM's clients. And notably, we created the world's first wireless pacemaker programmer and an innovative device that revolutionised lung biopsies, making the procedure easier, safer and painless. It's fulfilling when you see technology you have developed widely adopted, especially in healthcare. Recently I spotted one of these pacemaker programmers on a doctor's desk at a local hospital here in Bangalore, and this was a vivid reminder of the meaningful impact of our work.

Now taking a more recent example, as Kyndryl CTO for India, I'm leading the implementation of a transformative digital platform for a major Indian fintech, and this platform has significantly enhanced financial inclusion by enabling secure, scalable, accessible